SPECIFICATION OF THE CONTROLLED DESIGNATION OF ORIGIN "PATRIMONIO"

Decree no. 2011-782 of 28 June 2011 – JORF no. 0150 of 30 June 2011 relating to the controlled designation of origin "Patrimonio"

NOR: AGRT1110107D

CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the specific provisions set out below may claim the controlled designation of origin "Patrimonio", initially recognised by the decree of 13 March 1968.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

No particular provision.

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Patrimonio" is reserved for still white, red and rosé wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

1° – Geographical area

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines are carried out within the territory of the following communes of the Haute-Corse department: Barbaggio, Farinole, Oletta, Patrimonio, Poggio-d'Oletta, Saint-Florent and Santo-Pietro-di-Tenda.

2° – Delimited parcel area

The wines come exclusively from vines situated within the delimited parcel production area as approved by the National Institute of Origin and Quality at the session of the competent national committee of 10 February 1972. The National Institute of Origin and Quality lodges with the town halls of the communes referred to in 1° the graphic documents establishing the parcel boundaries of the production area thus approved.

3° – Immediate proximity area

The immediate proximity area, defined by derogation for the vinification, the elaboration and the ageing of the wines, is made up of the territory of the commune of Olmeta-di-Tuda of the Haute-Corse department.

V. – Grape varieties

1° – Grape varieties

a) – The white wines come from the vermentino B variety (malvoisie de Corse).

b) – The red and rosé wines come from the following varieties: - main variety: nielluccio N; - accessory varieties: grenache N, sciaccarello N, vermentino B (malvoisie de Corse).

2° – Proportion rules on the holding

The conformity of the grape varieties is assessed, for the colour considered, over all of the parcels of the holding producing the wine of the controlled designation of origin.

a) – Red wines: The proportion of the nielluccio N variety is greater than or equal to 90 % of the grape varieties.

b) – Rosé wines: The proportion of the nielluccio N variety is greater than or equal to 75 % of the grape varieties.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) – Planting density.
The vines present a minimum planting density of 4,000 plants per hectare. These vines may not present a spacing between rows greater than 2.80 metres and a spacing between plants within the same row less than 0.80 metre.

b) – Pruning rules.
The vines are pruned by short spur pruning (trained in goblet or Royat cordon) with a maximum of 10 free eyes (buds) per plant.

c) – Trellising rules and foliage height.
- The training of the vine makes it possible to have 1.4 square metres of external surface of plant cover for the production of one kilogram of grapes. - For the trellised vines, the height of trellised foliage is measured between the lower limit of the foliage, established at least 0.30 metre above the ground, and the upper topping limit, established at least 0.20 metre above the upper trellising wire.

d) – Average maximum load per parcel.
The average maximum load per parcel is fixed at 8,000 kilograms per hectare.

e) – Threshold for missing vines.
The percentage of dead or missing vine plants, referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code, is fixed at 20 %.

f) – Cultivation condition of the vine.
The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

g) – Chemical weedkiller.
The use of chemical weedkillers is prohibited.

2° – Irrigation

Irrigation is prohibited.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

The wines come from grapes harvested at proper ripeness.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

The sugar richness of the grapes and the natural alcoholic strengths by volume meet the following characteristics:

COLOUR OF THE WINES	MINIMUM SUGAR RICHNESS OF THE GRAPES (grams per litre of must)	MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME
White wines	178	11 %
Rosé wines	187	11.5 %
Red wines	207	12 %

VIII. – Yields. – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 50 hectolitres per hectare.

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is fixed at 55 hectolitres per hectare.

3° – Entry into production of young vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may be granted to wines coming from: - parcels of young vines only from the 2nd year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July; - parcels of young vines only from the 1st year following that in the course of which grafting in place was carried out before 31 July; - parcels of vines that have been top-grafted, at the earliest in the 1st year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, and once the parcels no longer contain any varieties other than those permitted for the appellation. By way of derogation, in the year following that in the course of which the top-grafting was carried out before 31 July, the varieties permitted for the appellation may represent only 80 % of the grape varieties of each parcel concerned.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) – Blending of the varieties.
The wines come from the blending of grapes or of wines in the same proportions as those provided for the grape varieties.

b) – Malolactic fermentation.
The malolactic fermentation is completed for the red wines. The red wines present, at the packaging stage, a maximum malic acid content of 0.4 gram per litre.

c) – Analytical standards.
The wines present, after fermentation, a content of fermentable sugars (glucose and fructose) conforming to the following characteristics:

COLOUR OF THE WINES AND MINIMUM NATURAL ALCOHOLIC STRENGTH BY VOLUME	**MAXIMUM CONTENT OF FERMENTABLE SUGARS (glucose and fructose) (grams per litre)**
White, rosé and red wines whose natural alcoholic strength by volume is less than or equal to 14 %	4
White, rosé and red wines whose natural alcoholic strength by volume is greater than 14 %	5

d) – Oenological practices and physical treatments.
- Any enrichment operation is prohibited; - the use of wood chips is prohibited; - the use of charcoals for oenological use is prohibited.

e) – Vat capacity.
Every operator has a global vat capacity at least equivalent to the total volume vinified.

f) – Good overall upkeep of the cellar (floors and walls) and equipment (hygiene).
The cellar (floors and walls) and the vinification equipment present a good general condition of upkeep.

2° – Provisions by type of product

a) – The white and rosé wines are the subject of an ageing at least until 15 December of the year of harvest.

b) – The red wines are the subject of an ageing at least until 15 February of the year following that of the harvest.

3° – Provisions relating to packaging

For each packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body: - the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code; - an analysis carried out before or after packaging. The analysis reports must be kept for a period of 6 months from the date of packaging.

4° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator demonstrates a specific place for the storage of the packaged products.

5° – Provisions relating to the movement of products and to placing on the market for the consumer

a) – Date of placing on the market for the consumer.
- At the end of the ageing period, the white and rosé wines are placed on the market for the consumer from 1 January of the year following that of the harvest; - at the end of the ageing period, the red wines are placed on the market for the consumer from 1 March of the year following that of the harvest.

b) – Period during which the wines may not move between approved warehouse keepers.
The wines may move between approved warehouse keepers at the earliest on 15 December of the year of harvest.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) – Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

Situated at the foot of Cap Corse and open onto the gulf of Saint-Florent, the geographical area lies within a vast amphitheatre that widens out with its plain, its hills and its valleys. It is closed to the east, towards Bastia, and to the south, towards the désert des Agriates, by a dense hydrographic network of small coastal rivers and by a line of crests. It thus extends over the territory of 7 communes of the Haute-Corse department and covers the region of the Nebbiu (meaning “fog”, in the Corsican language). The relief is powerful, in the image of the dislocations that shook the region in the Secondary era. The geological substratum is composed of glaucophane schists (schistes lustrés) of the ocean floor covered by sedimentary contributions, to the west, and crystalline contributions, to the east. This geological context is at the origin of a landscape of calcareous hills with rounded summits and of a monoclinal depression that runs from Poggio-d’Oletta to Farinole. The essential part of the vineyard is established at the heart of this depression known as the “Conca d’Oro” (meaning “rich conch”), perched a few tens of metres above the sea and marked by a detailed topography, on the slopes of the hillsides, or locally in the well-drained maritime plain, as to the north-west of the commune of Patrimonio. The vine occupies the great majority of the cultivated surfaces, whereas the plant mantle of the non-cultivated zones is a dense maquis, often impenetrable, dotted with wild olive trees or with groves of holm oaks in the small valleys. The originality of the territory of “Patrimonio” lies in the complexity of the soils of this depression, very different according to the communes, the altitude and the proximity of the sea, and which are clayey-calcareous for the most part, to the west, very stony and schistose towards Poggio-d’Oletta, to the east. The Mediterranean climate benefits from the moderating effect linked to the proximity of the sea on this cirque open towards the setting sun. The seasonal winds that are the Maestrale, a north-west wind, and the Libecciu, a south-west wind, strongly influence the vegetation. The thermal ranges are moderate.

b) – Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Corsican viticulture goes back to antiquity. The Greeks introduce the vine 6 centuries before Jesus Christ, then the Romans develop the trade beyond the island. With the fall of the Roman Empire, the export of wine becomes rare and viticulture is not relaunched until the 11th century, with the Pisans, for, in particular, the production of mass wine. With Genoa, in the 15th century, viticulture, and more particularly “Patrimonio”, occupies a place of choice. At the end of the 18th century, the wines of the region of the Nebbiu, loaded onto sailing ships at Saint-Florent, go round Cap Corse and are unloaded at Bastia. There they are tasted and receive, if they have happily withstood the ordeal, the right to export under the denomination “vini navigati” (wines that have sailed). Engaged the first in a voluntarist approach towards quality, the producers of “Patrimonio” lodge a first request for recognition as controlled designation of

origin as early as 1942. Regulatory constraints and the particular situation of the island allow the signature of the recognition decree only in the spring of 1968. The vineyard of "Patrimonio" covers, in 2008, an area of 410 hectares for a production of 14,200 hectolitres elaborated within 32 private cellars.

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the product

The red wines represent 40 % of the production. They are elaborated from the nielluccio N variety, present at least in a proportion of 90 % in the grape varieties and in the blend, which confers on them a tannic structure and a strong frame, guarantees of a good ageing potential. Their robe is very coloured, bright red, ruby or garnet, and they present natural alcoholic strengths by volume often high, greater than 13 %. The aromas of youth, recalling red fruits such as blackcurrant or blackberry, sometimes with woody nuances, evolve, with time, towards spicy aromas, but also grilled and balsamic notes. The rosé wines are most often the fruit of a subtle blend in which the nielluccio N variety is present in a proportion of at least 75 %, and is associated with the sciaccarello N, grenache N and vermentino B varieties. They are still dry wines, offering a bright pink robe, well balanced and with aromatic accents recalling raspberry and redcurrant. Generally tasted in their youth, they are synonymous with freshness. The white wines, still and dry, are elaborated exclusively from the vermentino B variety, which generally confers on them a great aromatic richness. The floral aromas, recalling white flowers, hawthorn or broom, are particularly marked when the wines are young.

3° – Causal interactions

This small, lively and rich region, well sheltered from the winds and remarkably exposed to the setting sun, produces the Corsican wines among the best known and the first recognised controlled designation of origin of the island. The Mediterranean climate, the topography in the form of a monoclinal depression and the calcareous soil permit nielluccio N to be the master of the varieties of the vineyard of "Patrimonio". It reigns as master in the universe of Bacchus since it is the blood of Jupiter, "sanguis jovis", a blood that the limestone of "Patrimonio" renders rich and very coloured. A marker of the Corsican ampelographic heritage, nielluccio N is to "Patrimonio" what sciaccarello N is to "Ajaccio". The hills intertwine at the heart of the geographical area, sheltering from the wind the vines that receive with all their leaves deployed the warm sun, without having to suffer too much from the hazards of the drying summer winds. The parcel area precisely delimited for the harvesting of the grapes classifies the parcels, sheltered by the reliefs, benefiting from the best exposures and from the maritime influences, and presenting soils essentially clayey-calcareous or locally developed on calcareous or glaucophane schists. These situations impose an optimal management of the plant and of its production potential, reflected in the training of the vine, a short spur pruning and controlled yields. They are expressed by the aromatic richness of the wines, the fine tannic seat of the red wines and the generosity of the rosé wines. The presence of the vine, favoured by the natural environment, is above all the work of the know-how of the winegrowing community, which has known how to select the best sites, to maintain a traditional grape mix and an elaboration of wines that have known how to resist the spirit of the times to defend their identity and end up imposing it on informed consumers. The vineyard is parcelled into small properties where the know-how of people, acquired over the generations, has permitted the expression of noble wines, marvellously translating the particular signs of the great Corsican varieties. Since the thirtieth anniversary of the controlled designation of origin "Patrimonio" (11 November 1998), "A San Martino", "La Saint-Martin", the patronal festival of the winegrowers and of sharing, is inscribed in the tradition. The broaching of the new vintage escorted by the Bacchic brotherhood is the occasion each year for a convivial moment.

XI. – Transitional measures

The vine parcels in place at the date of 31 July 2009 and whose planting density is between 3,000 plants per hectare and 4,000 plants per hectare continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin, until they are grubbed up, subject to compliance with the following provisions: - the average maximum load per parcel is fixed at 6,000 kilograms per hectare; - the volume able to benefit from the right to the controlled designation of origin is established on the basis of the yield authorised for the controlled designation of origin, for the harvest considered, affected by the coefficient of 0.80.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin "Patrimonio" is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be declared, after the harvest, offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in the harvest declaration, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices and any containers whatsoever, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1. Declaration of renunciation to produce

Every operator declares to the defence and management body, before 1 June preceding the harvest, the parcel(s) for which it renounces to produce the controlled designation of origin. The defence and management body transmits this declaration to the approved control body as soon as possible.

2. Claim declaration

The claim declaration must be sent to the defence and management body within a minimum time limit of fifteen days before any movement of the wines between approved warehouse keepers and at the latest on 25 November of the year of harvest. The defence and management body will transmit a copy to the approved control body. It indicates: - the appellation claimed; - the volume of wine; - the EVV or SIRET number; - the name and address of the applicant; - the place of storage of the wine. It is accompanied by: - a copy of the harvest declaration, and, as the case may be, a copy of the production declaration or an extract of the stock accounts for the buyers of grapes and musts; - and the general plan of the places of storage, permitting in particular the number, the designation and the capacity of the containers to be identified.

3. Transaction declaration and declaration relating to the dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine

Every operator wishing to market in bulk a wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must make to the approved control body a transaction declaration at least eight working days before the first removal and within a maximum time limit of two working days after the transaction. Every operator wishing to carry out a dispatch outside the national territory of a non-packaged wine benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must make the declaration thereof to the approved control body at least eight working days before dispatch. The operator must specify the colour and the volumes concerned.

4. Prior declaration of packaging

Every operator wishing to package a wine of the controlled designation of origin must send to the approved control body a prior declaration of packaging at least three working days before the start of the packaging period. The operator must specify the colour and the volumes concerned.

6. Downgrading declaration

Every operator carrying out a downgrading of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin must make the declaration thereof to the defence and management body and to the approved control body within a maximum time limit of eight working days after this downgrading.

II. – Keeping of registers

No particular provisions.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	

A1 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area.	Documentary check.
A2 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties and proportion rules, monitoring of the transitional measures, planting density).	Documentary check and check in the field.
A3 – Processing, ageing, packaging and storage facility. — Global vat capacity.	Documentary check and on-site check.
Place of vinification.	On-site check.
Place of storage.	On-site check.
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard. — Pruning.	Check in the field.
Average maximum load per parcel.	Check in the field.
Irrigation.	Documentary check and check in the field.
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes. — Ripeness of the grapes.	Documentary check and check in the field.
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage. — Oenological practices and physical treatments (enrichment, prohibited practices…).	Documentary check and on-site check.
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration. — Missing vines.	Documentary check (keeping of register) and check in the field.
Authorised yield.	Documentary check.
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Before and/or after packaging or at the stage of placing on the market for the consumer.	Documentary check and analytical examination.
At the stage of the bulk removals or at the stage of placing on the market for the consumer.	Organoleptic examination.
Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory.	Analytical and organoleptic examination of all the lots.

II. – References concerning the control structure

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The check of compliance with the present specification is carried out by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence, under the authority of the INAO, on the basis of an approved inspection plan.

The inspection plan sets out the self-checks carried out by the operators on their own activity and the internal checks carried out under the responsibility of the defence and management body. It indicates the external checks carried out by the third-party body as well as the analytical and organoleptic examinations. The whole of the checks is carried out by sampling. Non-packaged wines intended for a dispatch outside the national territory are the subject of a systematic analytical and organoleptic check.